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United States Patent	12386242
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	August 12, 2025
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Systems and methods for capturing filter data on a matte box

Abstract

A matte box for a camera includes a frame, a filter tray holder having at least one stage configured to receive a filter, and at least one filter tray configured to support the filter. The at least one filter tray is removably coupled to the filter tray holder at the at least one stage so that the filter is positioned in front of a lens of the camera. The matte box also includes a filter information system that has an identification tag coupled to the at least one filter tray and/or the filter. The identification tag includes informational data regarding the filter. A reader device supported on the frame and configured to receive the informational data from the identification tag. The filter information system records the informational data of the filter received in the filter tray holder.

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Appl. No.: 18/420919

Filed: January 24, 2024

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20240241427 A1	Jul. 18, 2024

Related U.S. Application Data

continuation parent-doc US 17636131 US 11921402 WO PCT/US2020/049319 20200904 child-doc US 18420919
us-provisional-application US 62896679 20190906

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: G03B11/00 (20210101); G06K7/10 (20060101); G06K19/07 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC G03B11/00 (20130101); G06K7/10366 (20130101); G06K19/0723 (20130101);

Field of Classification Search

USPC: None

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/636,131, filed Feb. 17, 2022, now U.S. Pat. No. 11,921,402, which is a National Stage Application of PCT/US2020/049319, filed Sep. 4, 2020, which claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 62/896,679, filed Sep. 6, 2019, the entire disclosures of which are incorporated herein by reference in their entireties. To the extent appropriate, a claim of priority is made to each of the above disclosed applications.

INTRODUCTION

(1) Cameras for photography and video (e.g., filmmaking and cinema) can use a matte box that attaches to a front of a camera lens. The matte box blocks unwanted light from hitting the lens, and also, houses removable filters that are placed in front of the lens. A filter tray is usually used to hold the filter and the tray is secured to the matte box so that any light that hits the front of the camera lens must travel through the filter therein. Filters can include polarizing filters, diffusion filters, daylight, day for night, neutral density filters, etc. Some known filter trays can also rotate in the matte box. Digital cameras have the ability to include information about the camera in a generated picture or video file and display the information on a camera user interface screen. For example, the camera information can include shutter angle, ISO (e.g., light sensitivity), lens settings (e.g., aperture, focal length, focal distance), etc. Matte box information such as filter type, however, is not included in this electronic informational data.

SUMMARY

(2) In an aspect, the technology relates to a matte box for a camera including: a frame; a filter tray holder having at least one stage configured to receive a filter; at least one filter tray configured to support the filter, wherein the at least one filter tray is removably coupled to the filter tray holder at the at least one stage so that the filter is positioned in front of a lens of the camera; and a filter information system including: an identification tag coupled to the at least one filter tray and/or the filter, wherein the identification tag includes informational data regarding the filter; and a reader device supported on the frame and configured to receive the informational data from the identification tag, wherein the filter information system records the informational data of the filter received in the filter tray holder.

(3) In an example, the filter information system further includes a user interface supported on the frame and configured to visually display the informational data of the filter received in the filter tray holder. In another example, the filter information system further includes a time clock, and wherein during the recordation of the informational data of the filter, time information is logged. In still another example, the identification tag is a radio-frequency identification (RFID) tag and the RFID tag is encoded with the informational data, and wherein the reader device is a RFID reader device. In yet another example, the recordation of the information data is based on an inductive coupling signal by the RFID reader device. In an example, the filter information system records a position of the filter within the filter tray holder. In another example, the at least one stage includes a plurality of stages and the reader device is disposed at one end of the plurality of stages, and wherein the position of the filter is based on signal strength in relation to the reader device.

(4) In another aspect, the technology relates to a matte box for a camera including: a frame; a filter tray holder having a plurality of stages configured to receive a filter; at least one filter tray configured to support the filter, wherein the at least one filter tray is removably coupled to the filter tray holder at one of the plurality of stages so that the filter is positioned in front of a lens of the camera; and a filter information system configured to record informational data regarding the filter

received in the filter tray holder.

(5) In an example, a mounting plate is configured to secure the matte box to the lens of the camera, wherein the mounting plate includes a circumferential lock ring and a quick release lever, the quick release latch pivotable about three discrete pivot points to frictionally secure the circumferential lock ring to the lens of the camera. In another example, the filter tray holder includes two opposing sidewalls that at least partially define the plurality of stages, wherein a release lever is supported on a first sidewall of the two opposing sidewalls and biased to releasably engage at least a portion of the at least one filter tray, and a locking lever is supported on a second sidewall of the two opposing sidewalls and biased to releasably engage at least a portion of the at least one filter tray, and wherein the locking lever includes a positioning lock that locks the position of the locking lever with respect to the second sidewall.

(6) In still another example, at least one flag is disposed opposite of the filter tray holder, wherein the matte box further includes at least one riser having a first undercut surface supported on the filter tray holder, and the at least one flag includes at least one clamp having a second undercut surface, wherein the first undercut surface engages with the second undercut surface when the at least one flag is coupled to the filter tray holder, and wherein the at least one clamp is slidable in a direction substantially parallel to the second undercut surface so as to selectively release the at least one clamp from the at least one riser. In yet another example, at least one flag is disposed opposite of the filter tray holder, wherein the at least one flag includes: a first flag member defining an elongated first track; a second flag member coupled to the first flag member with a gap therebetween; a pair of side flag members at least partially disposed in the gap between the first flag member and the second flag member, wherein each of the pair of side flag members define an elongated second track; and a screw clamp slidably engaged with the elongated first track and the elongated second tracks, wherein as the screw clamp slides within the elongated first track, the corresponding movement in the elongated second tracks extends or retracts the pair of side flag members in a direction that is substantially orthogonal to the elongated first track.

(7) In an example, the at least one filter tray includes: a body configured to at least partially surround a perimeter of the filter; and a compression clamp configured to secure the filter to the body, wherein the compression clamp includes: a clamp configured to engage an edge of the filter; a rod coupled to the clamp, wherein the rod is slidably and rotatably supported by the body, and wherein the rod includes a threaded portion; and a block threadably engaged with the rod and captured at least partially within the body, wherein the block is moveable between at least a first position and a second position relative to the body via rotation of the rod, when the block is in the first position, the rod is slidable relative to the body such that the clamp is moveable in a direction substantially orthogonal to the edge of the filter, and when the block is in the second position, the block is engaged with the body and preventing the rod from sliding to secure the clamp to the filter. In another example, the filter identification system includes: a radio-frequency identification (RFID) tag coupled to the at least one filter tray and/or the filter, wherein the identification tag includes the informational data regarding the filter; a RFID reader device supported on the frame and configured to receive the information data from the identification tag; and a user interface supported on the frame and configured to visually display the information data of the filter received in the filter tray holder.

(8) In another aspect, the technology relates to a method of capturing informational data of a filter within a matte box for a camera, the method including: encoding a radiofrequency identification (RFID) tag with the informational data of the filter, wherein the RFID tag is coupled to a filter tray that supports the filter and/or the filter; transmitting a reader signal by a RFID reader device supported on a frame of the matte box; receiving a response signal from the RFID tag at the RFID reader device containing the informational data of the filter; recording the informational data at the matte box; and visually displaying at least a portion of the informational data on a user interface of the matte box.

(9) In an example, the method further includes determining a position of the filter within the matte box, recording the position, and displaying the position on the user interface. In another example, recording the informational data includes logging time information from a time clock running within the matte box. In still another example, transmitting the reader signal by the RFID reader device is based on an inductive coupling signal of the RFID tag being disposed adjacent the RFID reader device. In yet another example, the method further includes sending at least a portion of the recorded information data to the camera. In an example, the method further includes syncing a running time clock within the matte box with an external timecode generator.

(10) These and various other features as well as advantages that characterize the matte boxes described herein will be apparent from a reading of the following detailed description and a review of the associated drawings. Additional features are set forth in the description which follows, and in part will be apparent from the description, or may be learned by practice of the technology. The benefits and features of the technology will be realized and attained by the structure particularly pointed out in the written description and claims hereof as well as the appended drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The following drawing figures, which form a part of this application, are illustrative of described technology and are not mean to limit the scope of the invention as claimed in any manner, which scope shall be based on the claims appended hereto.

(2) FIG. 1 is a side view of a camera and a prior art matte box.

(3) FIG. 2 is a rear perspective view of an exemplary matte box.

(4) FIG. 3 is an exemplary flowchart for capturing informational data of a filter within a matte box.

(5) FIG. 4 is a perspective view of an exemplary display device.

(6) FIG. 5 is a rear perspective view of another exemplary matte box.

(7) FIG. 6 is a rear perspective view of another exemplary matte box.

(8) FIG. 7 is a perspective view of another exemplary matte box.

(9) FIG. 8 is a rear view of a frame of the matte box shown in FIG. 7.

(10) FIG. 9 is a rear view of a filter tray and a filter of the matte box shown in FIG. 7.

(11) FIG. 10 is a rear perspective view of a filter tray holder of the matte box shown in FIG. 7.

(12) FIG. 11 is a partial rear view of the filter tray holder shown in FIG. 10.

(13) FIG. 12 is a rear view of a mounting plate of the filter tray holder shown in FIG. 10.

(14) FIG. 13 is a top view of a flag of the matte box shown in FIG. 7.

(15) FIG. 14 is a perspective view of a mounting bracket of the flag shown in FIG. 13.

(16) FIG. 15 is a partial cross-sectional view of the mounting bracket shown in FIG. 14.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(17) It is to be understood that both the foregoing introduction and the following detailed description are exemplary and explanatory and are intended to provide further explanation of the invention as claimed. Throughout this description, references to orientation (e.g., front(ward), rear(ward), top, bottom, back, right, left, upper, lower, etc.) of the matte box relate to its position when installed on a camera and are used for ease of description and illustration only. No restriction is intended by use of the terms regardless of how the matte box is situated on its own.

(18) The matte boxes described herein are configured to capture filter information (e.g., name, type, position, etc.) from the filters disposed therein and use the filter information to increase operational performance of the matte box. Additionally, the captured filter information increases efficiencies during post-operation of the matte box when working with the camera files. For example, by capturing filter information directly on the matte box, the filter information is automatically displayed directly on the matte box so as to assist users thereof. Additionally, the

filter information is recorded so that post-production use of camera files can have the filter information incorporated therein, thereby increasing post-production efficiencies that use the filter information. In examples, the filters have an associated tag that is read by a reader system within the matte box. The information from the tag (e.g., filter name, type, position, etc.) can be displayed on the matte box, as well as recorded for later use. Additionally, the matte box can determine a position (e.g., stage position, vertical position, rotational position) of the filter within the matte box for display and recordation. In some examples, the filter information can be sent directly to the camera and embedded within the files, while in other examples, the filter information can be meshed with the camera files after the camera files are generated.

(19) Furthermore, the matte boxes described herein are configured to increase overall performance of the matte box during use. For example, a quick release lock ring is provided so that the matte box is more easily securable to the front of the camera lens. A filter tray holder of the matte box includes a pair of levers that make securing the filter and filter tray to the matte box more secure and efficient. A filter tray includes a compression clamp that makes securing the filter to the filter tray more secure and efficient. A flag includes a clamp connection system that allows the flag to be easily snapped on the matter box, while also enabling a quick release. The flag also includes side members that are extendable and retractable with a single screw clamp.

(20) FIG. 1 is a side view of a camera **100** and a prior art matte box **102**. The camera **100** includes one or more display screens **104** (e.g., a primary and a secondary display) and a lens assembly **106**. Attached to the front of the lens assembly **106** is the matte box **102**. The matte box **102** includes a frame **108** having a first end **110** that is sized and shaped to be removably attached to the lens assembly **106** and an opposite second end **112** that extends from the front of the camera **100** when the matte box **102** is attached. In the example, the first end **110** of the matte box **102** is attached to the camera **100** by a swing arm **113** coupled to one or more of a pair of rods **114** disposed underneath the lens assembly **106**. This is called a rod mounted matte box. In other examples, the first end **110** of the matte box **102** can be attached directly to the front of the lens assembly **106**. The second end **112** can include one or more flags attached to the outer perimeter. For example, a top flag **116**, a bottom flag (not shown), and left and/or right flags **118**. The flags **116**, **118** and the second end **112** are configured to block light from hitting the front of the lens assembly **106**. In some examples, the matte box **102** can also include a removable matte (not shown) that couples to the second end **112** of the frame **108** so as to block the lens assembly **106** and define an aspect ratio, for example.

(21) Between the first end **110** and the second end **112** the frame **108** includes a filter tray holder **120**. The filter tray holder **120** has one or more stages that are each configured to receive a filter tray **122** that holds a filter (not shown). In the example, the filter tray holder **120** includes three stages, a forward stage **124**, a rearward stage **126**, and a middle stage, so that three filter trays **122** with filters can be used. In other examples, the filter tray holder **120** can have any other number of stages as required or desired (e.g., a single stage, two stages, five stages, etc.). In some examples, at least a portion of the filter tray holder **120** (e.g., the second stage **126**) can rotate R about a longitudinal axis **128** that extends between the first end **110** and the second end **112** of the frame **108**. The filter(s) supported by the matte box **102** selectively transmits light of different wavelengths as required or desired.

(22) In operation, filter tags **130**, **132** can be used to visually display the information of which filters are disposed within the filter tray holder **120** (e.g., position and type). The filter tags **130**, **132** are typically placed on the side of the second end **112** and made of tape or Velcro and are often hand written. For example, top filter tag **130** can provide filter type information for the filter within the forward stage **124**, while bottom filter tag **132** can provide filter type information of the filter within the rearward stage **126**. Generally, the order of the filter tags **130**, **132** is from top to bottom and corresponds to the filters ordered from front to back in the filter tray holder **120**. This filter type information can then (sometimes) be written down in an assistant's notes for further use. This

process, however, can often lead to filter type information being missing during post-production of the camera image (e.g., video or picture file) because everything is being done manually on set.

(23) FIG. 2 is a rear perspective view of an exemplary matte box **200**. Similar to the example described above, the matte box **200** includes a frame **202** and a filter tray holder **204** that is configured to be placed in front of a lens assembly of a camera (not shown). In this example, however, the filter tray holder **204** has three stages **206**, **208**, **210** axially spaced adjacent to one another along a longitudinal axis **212**. Each stage **206**, **208**, **210** is sized and shaped to hold a filter tray **214** with a filter **216** coupled thereto. This configuration enables the filter **216** to be placed in front of the lens assembly of the camera. In some examples, one or more of the stages **206**, **208**, **210** can allow for the filter tray **214** to rotate about the longitudinal axis **212** as required or desired. Additionally in this example, the matte box **200** includes a filter information system **218** that is configured to capture what filter **216** is disposed within the filter tray holder **204** and/or what position (e.g., stage) the filter **216** is placed within. In other examples, the filter tray holder **204** and/or filter **216** may be incorporated within a 3D camera set or rig such that the 3D camera has one or more filter stages and the filter information system **218**.

(24) The filter information system **218** includes a filter capture system **220** that is coupled in electronic communication with a reader device **222** coupled to and supported by the filter tray holder **204**. The filter capture system **220** is configured to capture the filter information data (e.g., by controlling the reader device **222**), and control the storage and display of the collected filter information data. Additionally, a tag **224** can be coupled to the filter **216** and/or the filter tray **214**. In the example, the tag **224** is coupled to the filter tray **214**. The tag **224**, however, can also be coupled directly to the filter **216** as required or desired. For example, the tag **224** can be attached around the edge of the filter **216** or the tag **224** can be embedded within the filter **216**. As such, the filter **216** can also be inserted directly within the matte box **200** and the filter tray **214** need not be used.

(25) In some examples, the filter capture system **220** and its components thereof may be supported within the frame **202** of the matte box **200**. In other examples, the filter capture system **220** and its components thereof may be housed in discrete display device. Examples of the display device are described below in reference to FIG. 4. The display device can be configured to removably couple to the exterior of the frame **202**. In some examples, the display device may removably slide or clip on and include electrical contacts so as to couple to the reader device **222**.

(26) In the example, the reader device **222** and tag **224** are a radio-frequency identification (RFID) system. For example, the RFID tag **224** is passive and the RFID reader device **222** is an active reader so that power does not have to be provided to the tag **224** and the filter tray **214** and/or filter **216**. It should be appreciated that the RFID system can be other types as required or desired, for example, a passive reader and an active tag. Additionally or alternatively, the reader device **222** and tag **224** system can be any other system that enables the matte box **200** to function as described herein. For example, an optical system (e.g., barcode or QR code), electrical contact system, solid state data system, physical read points, combinations of one or more systems, etc.

(27) The reader device **222** includes an antenna **226** that extends at least partially around a perimeter of the filter tray holder **204** so as to generate a signal that is able to read the RFID tag **224**. The antenna **226** can be supported on the filter tray holder **204** or the frame **202** as required or desired. In some examples, the antenna **226** can be a substantially straight wire. In other examples, the antenna **226** can be substantially circular so as to generate a substantially torus signal pattern. The antenna **226** generally extends in a shape that can more efficiently read the passive RFID tag **224** while reducing interference with other components of the matte box **200**. In some examples, the antenna **226** can include one or more signal shields (not shown) so as to direct the RFID signal in a direction substantially parallel to the longitudinal axis **212**. This enables the reader device **222** to read the replies from the tag **224** at any location on the filter tray **214** and/or the filter **216**. As such, the reader device **222** can also determine a rotational angle of the filter **216** relative to the

longitudinal axis **212** and/or an offset position (e.g., a direction substantially parallel to the longitudinal axis **212**) of the filter **216** within the filter tray **214** if the filter is only partially inserted within the filter tray holder **204**.

(28) Additionally, RFID signal strength can be used to determine the position of the filter **216** within the stages **206**, **208**, **210**. This position of the filter **216** is axially along the longitudinal axis **212**. Further, the RFID signal can be directed specifically in relation to the matte box **200** so that adjacent tags (e.g., on the filter trays that are not being used and still located within the camera bag) are not read and picked-up. In other examples, the reader device **222** can be disposed within the filter capture system **220** as required or desired. In the example, by placing the antenna **226** around the perimeter of the filter tray holder **204**, the antenna does not obstruct the view of the camera. In other examples, the antenna **226** may be disposed within the display device illustrated in FIG. 4. In still other examples, the antenna **226** may be split into two or more discrete antennas disposed on the matte box **200**.

(29) In the example, the filter information system **218** (e.g., filter capture system **220** and reader device **222**) may be integral with the matte box **200** (e.g., built into the matte box) or can be a separate kit that removably attaches to the matte box **200** as required or desired. For example, the filter information system **218** may be a kit that can upgrade the prior art matte box **102** described in FIG. 1. It should be appreciated that the components of the filter information system **218** can be separated between the matte box, camera, etc. and so as to enable filter informational data to be used during post-production work of the camera files.

(30) In certain aspects, the filter capture system **220** is a computing device that includes at least one processor **228**, at least one memory **230**, a power source **232** (e.g., a battery), a communication device **234**, and a display screen **236**. The filter capture system **220** acts as a controller for the reader device **222** and also can provide the power thereto (e.g., via electrical contact connectors). The communication device **234** enables the filter capture system **220** on the matte box **200** to couple in communication to one or more remote device(s) (e.g., a camera, a user device, or any other external device such as a timecode generator). These communication connections can be in a wired communication network or a wireless communication network. Wireless communication can include infrared, BLUETOOTH®, wireless technology, WiFi, cellular, or other frequency communication systems as required or desired.

(31) In the example, the filter capture system **220** can couple in communication to a camera **238** and/or a user device **240** (e.g., a smartphone, tablet, or other computing device). In some examples, the user device **240** and the camera **238** can also couple in direct communication as required or desired. The filter capture system **220** and/or user device **240** can also couple in communication to any other remote device (not shown) as required or desired. As such, data can be sent and received between the various components of the system as required or desired. For example, a remote timecode generator device (not shown) for a timecode sync.

(32) In an aspect, the user device **240** can couple to one or more remote devices (e.g., the camera **238** or another timecode device) to capture a generated timecode for a timecode sync. In another aspect, the filter capture system **220** can couple to one or more remote devices (e.g., the camera **238** or another time code device) to capture a generated timecode for a timecode sync. The filter capture system **220** can then store the information generated from the RFID tag **224** and the associated timecode. In some examples, this information may additionally or alternatively sent to the user device **240**.

(33) The filter capture system **220** may support a user interface that is operable by any number of input/output devices or ports as required or desired. For example, interface buttons, USB port, micro SD memory readers, etc. In an aspect, the RFID tag **224** information and the associated timecode can be stored in a removable micro SD card as well as any other information regarding the matte box **200** as required or desired for further use. In other aspects, the filter capture system **220** can send the RFID tag **224** information to the user device **240** and/or the camera **238** as

required or desired.

(34) Additionally or alternatively, the matte box **200** may include a matte (not shown) that is attached to the front of the frame **202**. The matte can be an aspect ratio matte that is used to block out a portion of the frame **202**. The matte can include an RFID tag or any other information reading system so that the filter information system **218** can also detect a matte type that is used with the camera **238**.

(35) FIG. **3** is an exemplary flowchart **300** for capturing informational data of the filter **216** within the matte box **200**. With continued reference to FIG. **2**, in operation, the tag **224** may be encoded (operation **302**) with informational data regarding the attached filter **216**. Filter informational data can be a type or name of the filter, a product number, a unique ID number, etc. In some examples, the informational data contains the type of the filter **216** and the tag **224** can be a read/write tag that can have data changed (e.g., for custom filter names). In other examples, the informational data includes a number or code that is related to the tag **224** (e.g., a read only tag) such that the tag **224** number can be related to the type of the filter **216** and contained in a database stored in the filter capture system **220**.

(36) The reader device **222** continuously (e.g., periodically) reads for the tag **224** so as to determine what filter is within the filter tray holder **204**. For example, the reader device **222** transmits a reader signal for the tag **224** (operation **304**). The transmission can occur upon a predetermined time period (e.g., every two seconds, every minute, etc.). In other examples, the reader device **222** can selectively read for the tag **224**, e.g., upon insertion or removal of the filter **216**. For example, when RFID tags are utilized, inductive coupling of the tag **224** can be used as a signal to read the tag **224** and collect information about the filter **216**. In other examples, inductive coupling induced by the tag **224** can be used to only wake up the reader device **222**, which then goes through the process of reading the tag **224**. The reader signal induces the tag **224** to reply to the reader device with a response signal (operation **306**). This response signal contains the informational data encoded within the tag **224**.

(37) Once the filter capture system **220** has the informational data of the filter **216** within the matte box **200**, the information data is recorded and stored (operation **308**). In this example, the type of the filter **216** may be stored in the informational data so it can be pulled directly from the response signal. In some examples, this stored information (e.g., filter type and/or position) can be stored in a removable memory device to then be used to mesh with the camera files in a separate process. In other examples, recording the informational data includes logging time information from a time clock running within the matte box **200** so that the filter data from the matte box is easier to mesh with other files. In still other examples, the information data may include select camera information, such as, but not limited to, camera lens information and/or focal length. In further examples, the filter capture system **220** can determine the type of the filter **216**. For example, the informational data includes a number or a code that is used to look-up the type of the filter **216** that is locally stored within a database. The type of the filter **216** (e.g., a name) pulled from the database can then be recorded along with a time stamp. In aspects, the informational data determined by the matter box **200** may be sent directly to the camera as required or desired.

(38) At least a portion of the informational data is then visually displayed on the display screen **236** of the filter capture system **220** and on the matte box **200** (operation **310**). This allows for the camera operator and/or camera assistants to visually see what filters **216** are within the matte box **200** without having to take the filters out. In some examples, the displayed position of the filters **216** (e.g., front to back) on the user interface can be modified on the display screen **236** via one or more buttons. In other examples, the reader device **222** can also determine the position of the filters **216**, record the filter position, and automatically display the position on the display screen **236** (operation **312**). For example, the reader device **222** can determine which stage **206**, **208**, **210** the filter **216** is located in. In other examples, the reader device **222** can determine what rotational angle (e.g., relative to the longitudinal axis **212**) the filter **216** is in. Determining the rotational

angle can be desirable when polarized filters or graduated filters are used. Additionally, rota-pola filters are typically positioned at the stage that is closest to the camera lens. In yet another example, the reader device can determine what vertical position the filter **216** is in. In some examples, the filter **216** may only be partially inserted into the matte box. In still other examples, the reader device can determine what tilt position the filter **216** or matte box is in. For example, the filter **216** may be tilted so as to reduce or prevent reflection, while in other examples, the filter tray holder may be tilted relative to the camera lens. These filter positions (e.g., stage, rotation, vertical, and/or tilt) can be determined by signal strength, tag location on the filter, or any other method that enables the position of the filter **216** to be determined as described herein.

(39) In some examples, the informational data of the filter **216** can also be sent to the camera **238** (operation **314**) via the filter capture system **220**. This enables the filter type to be displayed on the camera screen and/or included within the camera files, and enables the type of filter to be directly embedded within the camera files for use in post-production as required or desired. Additionally or alternatively, the informational data of the filter **216** can be sent to the user device **240** via the filter capture system **220**. The user device **240** can synchronize with a timecode generated on the camera or other timecode device so that the informational data of the filter **216** can be linked with the camera file without directly going through the camera (e.g., operation **312**). In other examples, the user device **240** can have its own timecode that includes the informational data of the filter **216**, which then is synchronized with the timecode from the camera **238**.

(40) In some examples, the filter capture system **220** can have its own running time clock that can be synced with an external timecode generate (operation **316**). The informational data of the filter and the timecode information can be stored locally within the filter capture system **220** for use (e.g., via a removable memory device), and/or stored internally or externally as required or desired.

(41) FIG. **4** is a perspective view of an exemplary display device **400**. As described above, the system components that are used to capture the filter information are mounted within the matte box itself. In this example, however, the display device **400** is utilized to house the system components so that it is easier to retrofit existing matte boxes and capture filter information. For example, the display device **400** can attach to the matte box using Velcro. The display device **400** includes a housing **402** for an internal reader device **404** that is configured to read an external tag that is coupled to the filter or filter tray (both not shown). A controller **406** (e.g., a circuit board with memory, processor, communication device, etc.) is used for operational control of the display device **400** and the reader device **404**. A battery compartment **408** allows the display device **400** to receive a power source so as to power the components within the display device **400**. In other examples, the reader device **404** may be coupled to an external power source, such as, being daisy chained through the camera and/or motor mount.

(42) The display device **400** also includes a user interface having a display screen **410** that is configured for a three stage matte box and includes three different display lines **412** for the filter type (e.g., filter name). It should be appreciated that the display device can be configured for any other stage matte box as required or desired, for example, two-stages, five stages, etc. Each display line **412** can be associated with a button **414**. The buttons **414** can be used to manually modify the position of the filter type on the display as required or desired. The display screen **410** can also be controlled by an interface/brightness button **416**.

(43) In examples, the display device **400** can include a database of common filter types so as to easily relate to the information of a tag. In some examples, the database can be modified so that custom filter types can be included as well as any other stored data as required or desired. In some examples, this modification may be performed via a USB connection. The buttons **414**, **416** can be used to facilitate this database modification. In other devices, the display device **400** can connect to a user device such that an application and user interface can be used to modify the filter type database. Additionally, in this example, the reader device antenna is disposed within the display device **400**.

(44) FIG. 5 is a rear perspective view of another exemplary matte box **500**. Similar to the examples described above, the matte box **500** includes a frame **502** and a filter tray holder **504** with three stages. Each stage is sized and shaped to receive a filter tray **506** that holds a filter **508**. A filter information system **510** includes a filter capture system **512** and a reader device **514** configured to read a tag **516**. In this example, however, each stage of the filter tray holder **504** includes its own reader device **514a**, **514b**, **514c** so as to more easily determine the stage position of each filter **508** via the tag **516**.

(45) FIG. 6 is a rear perspective view of another exemplary matte box **600**. Similar to the examples described above, the matte box **600** includes a frame **602** and a filter tray holder **604** with three stages. Each stage is sized and shaped to receive a filter tray **606** that holds a filter **608**. A filter information system **610** includes a filter capture system **612** and a reader device **614** configured to read a tag **616**. Similar to the example in FIG. 5, each stage of the filter tray holder **604** can include its own reader device **614a**, **614b**, **614c** so as to more easily determine the stage position of each filter **608** via the tag **616**. In this example, however, the reader device **614** may be located on a side of the filter tray holder **604** instead of the bottom (as in FIG. 5). By locating the reader device **614** on the side of the matte box **600**, access to the reader device **614** is easier.

(46) FIG. 7 is a perspective view of another exemplary matte box **700**. The matte box **700** includes a frame **702** and a filter tray holder **704**. The frame **702** acts as a shroud for the camera lens (not shown) and is described in more detail below and in reference to FIG. 8. The filter tray holder **704** has at least one stage configured to receive a filter **706**. In the example, the filter tray holder **704** has three stages, although other stage numbers (e.g., two, four, or five) are also contemplated herein. The filter tray holder **704** is described in more detail below and in reference to FIGS. 10-12. The filter **706** is supported by a filter tray **708**. The filter tray **708** is configured to be removably coupled to the filter tray holder **704** so as to selectively position the filter **706** in front of the camera lens. The filter tray **708** is described in more detail below and in reference to FIG. 9. The matte box **700** also includes at least one flag **710** removably coupled to the matte box **700** opposite of the filter tray holder **704** and configured to pivot relative thereto. The flag **710** is described in more detail below and in reference to FIGS. 13-15.

(47) In this example, the matte box **700** is configured to capture informational data of the filters **706** being used within the matte box and as described herein. The matte box **700** includes a filter information system **712** that is configured to read and record the informational data of the filters **706**. The filter information system **712** includes a user interface **714** supported on the frame **702** that enables the matte box user to interact with the matte box **700**. The user interface **714** can include a display screen **716** that is configured to visually display the informational data of the filter **706** received within the filter tray holder **704**. For example, the display screen **716** can display the name or type of the filter **706**. In other examples, a code or a symbol corresponding the name or type of the filter **706** can be displayed. In still other examples, the display screen **716** can be configured to display any other additional information regarding the matte box **700**. For example, camera lens type, focal length of the lens, hard matte use, aspect ratio, flag position, etc. The user interface **714** can also include one or more buttons **718** that assist with the use of the filter information system **712**. For example, the user can use the buttons **718** to move the position of the displayed filter **706**. In other examples, the buttons **718** can be used to control operations of the filter information system **712**. For example, initiate a time sync function, etc. The filter information system **712** is described in more detail below.

(48) FIG. 8 is a rear view of the frame **702** of the matte box **700** (shown in FIG. 7). A back cover of the frame **702** is illustrated as transparent so that the components of the filter information system **712** are shown. The back cover of the frame **702** is configured to be coupled to the filter tray holder **704** (shown in FIG. 7). The frame **702** has an opening **720** that allows light to reach the camera lens. The filter information system **712** is supported by the frame **702** and includes a controller **722** that is configured to record informational data regarding the filter(s) received in the filter tray

holder. In the example, the controller **722** is a circuit board with memory and processors that enable the matte box to function as described herein. It should be appreciated that the controller **722** can have any other structure that enables the filter information system **712** to function as described herein. The user interface **714** (display screen **716** and buttons **718**) is operable via the controller **722**.

(49) The filter information system **712** includes a reader device **724** supported on the frame **702** and configured to read informational data from a tag **726** (shown in FIG. **9**) disposed on a filter or filter tray. In the example, the reader device **724** is positioned at a top rail of the frame **702** and at the end of the plurality of stages. In this position, the reader device **724** has a relatively direct path to the filters and filter trays without interference from other components. In other examples, the reader device **724** can be positioned at any other location on the frame **702** as required or desired. In the example, the reader device **724** is a radio-frequency (RFID) active reader device and the tag **726** is an RFID passive tag. In other examples, the reader device and tag can be any other system that enables the matte box to function as described herein.

(50) A power source **728**, for example, a battery pack, can be used to power the filter information system **712**. In the example, the power source **728** is disposed opposite of the controller **722** and can have a removable cover for access to a removable or rechargeable battery pack. In other examples, the matte box can be coupled to an external power source as required or desired. For example, the matte box can couple to the camera and be powered by the camera. In another example, the matte box can couple to the lens motor control for the camera and be powered by the motor control. Other configurations are also possible. For example, the frame **702** may include a solar panel (not shown) so as to power the electronic components of the matte box.

(51) As illustrated, the power source **728** is disposed on one side of the frame **702** and the display screen **716** is disposed on the other. It should be appreciated, that components of the filter information system **712** can be disposed anywhere and/or duplicated as required or desired. For example, the each side of the frame **702** may include a display screen **716**.

(52) In operation, the reader device **724** receives informational data regarding the filter (e.g., type, name, etc.) and the controller **722** records the received information data and visually displays the informational data on the display screen **716**. In some examples, the reader device transmits a reader signal to gather the filter data on a predetermined time frequency. In other examples and by using an RFID system, the filter being inserted into or removed from the matte box generates an inductive coupling between the reader device **724** and the tag **726**, and this signal can be used to wake-up the reader device and trigger it to transmit a reader signal so that the informational data for the filter can be recorded. In this system, power consumption is more accurately controlled.

(53) In addition to the filter data from the tag **726**, the filter information system **712** can also determine stage position of the filter. This enables for the position sequence of multiple filters to be recorded and displayed. In an example, stage position of the filter can be determined by signal strength of the reader device **724** and tag **726** interaction. This can be enabled by the reader device **724** being substantially aligned with the position of the tag **726** on the filter tray when the filter tray is installed. Additionally or alternatively, rotational position of the filter can be determined by the filter information system **712**. For example, the rotational position of a polarized filter (e.g., a rota-pola filter) can be recorded and displayed. In further examples, a vertical position of the filter within the matte box (e.g., a partially inserted filter) can be determined by the filter information system **712**. For one or both of rotational and vertical positioning, the position can be based on signal strength, use of an elongated tag or multiple tags on the filter or filter tray, or any other method as required or desired.

(54) In another example, the filter information system **712** can read and detect specialized filter trays such as a diopter (e.g., used for close focus situations), a rota-pola (e.g., used for rotatable polarizing filters), and/or an anti-reflection (e.g., can tilt and eliminate reflections) (all not shown) coupled to the matte box. This can be done with a tag (e.g., a RFID tag) on the specialized tray or

any other tag/sensor as required or desired. Additionally, these specialized trays may also include additional features, for example, determining the rotational angle on the rota-pola tray, the tilt angle on the ant-reflection tray, and/or the focus information on the diopter. When the diopter, anti-reflection, and/or rota-pola is present, the filter information system **712** can indicate its presence on the display screen **716** and record the information for later use and as described herein.

(55) In the examples described herein, the matte box **700** is configured to read informational data regarding the attached filters, display the informational data, and sent the information data to other remote external devices. Additionally, the matter box **700** can receive and display informational data from the remote external devices. For example, a range finder (not shown) may be attached to the matte box **700**, and the range finder distance may be received and displayed on the matte box **700**. In some examples, the matte box **700** may include an accessory port (not shown) for coupling external devices to the matte box **700** (e.g., the range finder) and enabling data and electrical power to be transferred between.

(56) Once the filter informational data is recorded by the controller **722**, the data can be used to mesh with the camera files or any other file as required or desired during post production camera file work. For example, the informational data can be meshed with the camera file in a software program so that the filter type and/or position is easily known. In the example, the controller **722** has an external memory port **730** (e.g., a micro SD or the like) so that the informational data is recorded and can be transferred to another location for the meshing. In other examples, the informational data can be sent directly to the camera, if the camera and the matte box are coupled in communication together (e.g., wired or wireless).

(57) In some examples, the filter information system **712** includes a time clock so that time can be logged during the recordation of the filter data. This allows for the camera file to mesh with the filter data more easily. In some examples, the filter information system has an internal time clock that can be used to log time information with the filter information. In other examples, the matte box can couple to an external timecode device so that the internal time cock is based and synced with the external device. For example, before camera work begins, the camera, the matte box, as well as any other device, can all be synced with a master timecode device so that post production work is easier to mesh. To facilitate time clock syncing, the controller **722** can include one or more connector ports **732** that allows standardized timecode, power, and camera connectivity. The connector ports **732** can be located behind the memory port **730**. In other examples, one or more of the connector ports **732** may be located on a stationary portion of a swing away arm so that the connector port location is stationary relative to the camera. The connector ports **732** can include a LEMO connector port and/or any other connector type port (e.g., USB-C, R232, and the like) for wired connections. These connector ports can both send and receive information to and from the connected devices. For example, the LEMO connector port may be used for the time sync functionality with the timecode device and/or direct wired communication with the camera. In another example, the matte box may couple to the camera with a R232 type connector cable. In some examples, the wired connections may be located on a swing arm (not shown) of the matte box that is used to support the matte box on the rods of the camera mount. This position enables the matte box to daisy chain off of other camera components, such as, but not limited to a motor control unit (e.g., lens control motor). In other examples, the filter information system **712** can couple in wireless communication (e.g., Wi-Fi, Bluetooth, and the like) to any external device (e.g., camera, timecode device, etc.) as required or desired.

(58) In other examples, the filter information system **712** may include a gyroscopic sensor (not shown) for recording motion data information of the matte box **700**. Motion data can include acceleration, deceleration, and the like, and for use in stabilizing the captured images in post-production.

(59) FIG. **9** is a rear view of the filter tray **708** and the filter **706** of the matte box **700** (shown in FIG. **7**). The filter tray **708** is configured to releasably support the filter **706** and secure to the filter

tray holder **704** (shown in FIG. 7) of the matte box. The filter tray **708** includes a body **734** configured to at least partially surround a perimeter of the filter **706** and a compression clamp **736** configured to releasably secure the filter **706** to the body **734**. In the example, the body **734** has a handle **738** that extends therefrom and is configured to support the compression clamp **736**. Additionally, one or more notches **740** are defined in the sidewalls of the body **734**. The notches **740** can be utilized to secure the filter tray **708** within the filter tray holder **704** as described further below in reference to FIGS. **10** and **11**.

(60) The compression clamp **736** includes a clamp **742** that is configured to engage an edge of the filter **706** and compress the filter **706** at least partially against an opposing side of the body **734** so as to secure the filter **706** within the filter tray **708**. A rod **744** is rotatably coupled to the clamp **742** and defines a longitudinal axis **746**. The rod **744** is slidable and rotatably supported by the handle **738**. The rod **744** sliding S along the longitudinal axis **746** is used to move the clamp **742** substantially orthogonal to the edge of the filter **706** so that the filter **706** can be removed as required or desired. The rod **744** is also rotatable R around the longitudinal axis **746**. In the example, rotation of the rod **744** can selectively lock the position of the clamp **742** so as to prevent the filter **706** from being removed from the filter tray **708**.

(61) The rod **744** includes a threaded portion **748** that is threadingly engaged with a block **750**. The block **750** is captured at least partially within a channel **752** of the handle **738**. The block **750** is moveable along the longitudinal axis **746** between at least a first position and a second position within the channel **752** and via rotation R of the rod **744**. The block **750** is illustrated in the second position in FIG. **9**. In the second position, the block **750** is disposed at the top of the channel **752**, and as such, when the filter **706** is within the body **734**, the rod **744** is restricted from sliding S and the filter **706** is locked within the filter tray **708**. To unlock the filter **706**, the rod **744** is rotated R so as to slide the block **750** towards the first position (not shown) and at the bottom end of the channel **752**. This first position of the block **750** enables the rod **744** to slide S and release the clamp **742** from the filter **706**.

(62) In the example, the tag **726** is coupled to, or embedded within, the filter tray **708**. It should be appreciated that in other examples, the tag **726** can be coupled to, or embedded within the filter **706** itself. The tag **726** includes informational data regarding the filter **706** (e.g., type, name, code, or any other identifying information as required or desired) that can be read and collected by the reader device **724** (shown in FIG. **8**). In the example, the tag **726** can be a radio-frequency identification (RFID) tag encoded with the information data of the filter **706**. These RFID tags are programmable as required or desired so that the information about the filter **706** can be embedded within the tag **726**. Other reader/tag systems are also contemplated herein. The tags **726** can be configured to be readable by the reader device at any rotational or vertical position. Because the reader device reads the tags **726** through components of the matte box, the matte box (e.g., the frame, filter tray holder, filter trays, etc.) are constructed out of the materials that increase the efficiency and performance of the data reading system. For example, the filter tray **708** may be formed from a fiberglass, fiberglass type material, a nylon based material, or the like so that RFID signal penetration is increased.

(63) FIG. **10** is a rear perspective view of a filter tray holder **704** of the matte box **700** (shown in FIG. **7**). The filter tray holder **704** is configured to removably receive and secure one or more filter trays **708** so that the filter **706** (both shown in FIG. **9**) is positioned within the matte box and in front of the camera lens. The filter tray holder **704** includes a mounting plate **754** configured to secure the filter tray holder **704** to the lens of the camera. Opposite of the mounting plate **754**, the filter tray holder **704** includes a front plate **756** that the frame **702** (shown in FIG. **8**) mounts to. Between the plates **754**, **756**, the filter tray holder **704** includes two opposing sidewalls **758** and a bottom wall **760**. In some examples, the bottom wall **760** can be removable from the sidewalls **758**. The filter tray holder **704** defines an interior chamber **762** that is open on top so as to receive the filter trays **708**/filters **706**. One or more stages are defined within the interior chamber **762** and

correspond to the front-back position of the filter trays/filters. In some examples, one or more dividers (not shown) may be disposed within the interior chamber **762** so as to further define the stages. In the example, the filter tray holder **704** is a three-stage housing and configured to hold three filter trays/filters. In other examples, the filter tray holder **704** can include any other number of stages (e.g., two, four, five, etc.).

(64) As illustrated, the filter tray holder **704** is a top load tray holder, whereby the filter trays are loaded from the top. In other examples, the filter tray holder **704** may be a side load tray holder, whereby the opening to the interior chamber **762** is through one of the left or right sidewalls. In this aspect, the filter trays are loaded from the sides, however, the filter tray holder **704** can still include the features as described herein.

(65) FIG. **11** is a partial rear view of the filter tray holder **704**. With continued reference to FIG. **10**, one of the sidewalls **758** includes a release lever **764** and the other of the sidewalls **758** includes a locking lever **766**. The release lever **764** and the locking lever **766** are disposed on opposing sides of the interior chamber **762** and are configured to engage with the filter trays when inserted therein. The release lever **764** is pivotably supported at a pivot point **768** and one end of the lever **764** has a post **770** extending therefrom. The post **770** is configured to engage with the notch **740** on the filter tray **708** (both shown in FIG. **9**). In the example, the post **770** extends across all of the stages within the interior chamber **762**. The other end of the lever **764** is biased (e.g., via a spring **772**) so as to urge the post **770** in a direction towards the interior chamber **762**.

(66) The locking lever **766** is also pivotably supported at a pivot point **774** and one end of the lever **766** has a post **776** extending therefrom. The post **776** is configured to engage with the notch on the filter tray. In the example, the post **776** extends across all of the stages within the interior chamber **762**. The other end of the lever **764** is biased (e.g., via a spring **778**) so as to urge the post **776** in a direction towards the interior chamber **762**. Because both levers **764**, **766** are biased towards an engaging position with the filter tray, the filter tray can be slid into the filter tray holder **704** from the top and snap lock into place via the posts **770**, **776**. Additionally, to remove the filter tray, the release lever **764** can be depressed to overcome the spring **772** and release the post **770** so as to slide the filter tray out to the top of the filter tray holder **704**. The locking lever **766** does not necessarily need to be released as releasing one side of the filter tray allows removal of the filter tray.

(67) In the example, the locking lever **766** also includes a positioning lock **780** that is disposed adjacent the spring **778**. The positioning lock **780** is configured to lock the position of the locking lever **766** with respect to the sidewall **758** so that the post **776** cannot disengage with the filter tray. When the position of the locking lever **766** is fixed, the securement of the filter tray within the filter tray holder **704** is increased. In the example, the locking lever **766** is a thumb screw. In other examples, the positioning lock **780** is any other mechanical position lock that enables the locking lever **766** to function as described herein.

(68) FIG. **12** is a rear view of the mounting plate **754** of the filter tray holder **704** (shown in FIG. **10**). With continued reference to FIG. **10**, the mounting plate **754** includes an opening **782** that allows light to reach the camera lens. Surrounding the opening **782**, a circumferential lock ring **784** is configured to secure the filter tray holder **704** to the camera lens. The lock ring **784** has a first member **786** and a second member **788** that are configured to radially compress around the camera lens so as to fictionally secure the lock ring **784** to the camera lens. The free ends of each of the members **786**, **788** are coupled to a quick release latch **790** that is utilized to move the members **786**, **788**. In some examples, the mounting plate **754** may include two discrete plates, a forward plate that defines the chamber that receives the filters and filter trays, and a rearward plate that includes the circumferential lock ring **784**.

(69) In the example, the release latch **790** includes a lever **792** that is pivotably coupled to the free end of the second member **788** at a pivot point **794**. The release latch **790** also includes an adjustment arm **796** that is pivotably coupled to the free end of the first member **786** at a pivot

point **798**. Additionally, the release latch **790** and the adjustment arm **796** are coupled to each other at a pivot point **800**. The adjustment arm **796** includes a channel **802** so that the pivot point **800** can slide therein during operation of the release latch **790**. Additionally, a location of the pivot point **800** can be adjusted as required or desired by a screw bolt **804**. By adjusting the position of the pivot point **800**, the force required to close the release latch **790** can be increased or decreased. In operation, the three discrete pivot points **794**, **798**, **800** enable the lever **792** and arm **796** to rotate and radially compress the lock ring **784**. When the three pivot points are all linearly aligned, the lock ring **784** is in its most radially compressed position. As illustrated in FIG. **12**, however, the locked configuration of the release latch **790** has the pivot point **800** offset from the linear alignment of the most compressed position. As such, during the locking operation, the pivot point **800** rotates past the most compressed position so that to unlock the release latch **790** additional force has to be applied to the lever **792**, thereby providing additional securement to the release latch **790**. The screw bolt **804** includes a resilient washer **805** disposed proximate its end so as to enable at least some compression within the release latch **790** and allow movement between the locked and unlocked configurations.

(70) In some examples, the mounting plate **754** may include a reader (not shown) that reads information about the camera lens that it attaches to. In this example, a tag may be included on the camera lens and read informational data regarding the camera and/or camera lens. This enables, the filter information system described herein to also read, record, and/or display information regarding the camera lens. In other examples, a swing away arm or a fixed rod mount (not shown) may be coupled to the mounting plate **754** so that the matte box can be secured with the rods of the camera setup.

(71) FIG. **13** is a top view of the flag **710** of the matte box **700** (shown in FIG. **7**). The flag **710** includes a mounting bracket **806** that is configured to couple to the frame **702** (shown in FIG. **8**) and/or the filter tray holder **704** (shown in FIG. **10**). The mounting bracket **806** is described further below and in reference to FIGS. **14** and **15**. The flag **710** is pivotable relative to the mounting bracket **806** around a pivot axis **808**. The flag **710** includes top and bottom flag members **810** that are stacked on top of one another and separated by a gap. A pair of side flag members **812** are at least partially disposed in the gap and between the top and bottom flag members **810**. The top flag member **810** includes an elongated first track **814** that extends substantially orthogonal to the pivot axis **808**. The track **814** is configured to receive a screw clamp **816** that is slidable therein. Each of the side flag members **812** include an elongated second track **818** that also receives the screw clamp **816** such that it can slide therein. The second tracks **818** are disposed at an angle relative to the first track **814**.

(72) In operation, the screw clamp **816** can be used to extend and retract the side flag members **812** from the sides of the top and bottom flag members **810**. As illustrated in FIG. **13**, the side flag members **812** are in an extended position and the screw clamp **816** is at a distal end of the elongated first track **814**. The screw clamp **816** can be tightened so as to secure its position within the track **814** and hold the position of the side flag members **812**. To retract the side flag members **812**, the screw clamp **816** slides **820** towards the proximal end, and the corresponding movement in the elongated second tracks **818** retracts the side flag members **812**. That is, the screw clamp **816** also moves towards the proximal ends of the second tracks **818**, but because the second tracks **818** are angled, the side flag members retract in a direction **822**. To extend the side flag members, the screw clamp **816** slides **820** towards the distal end. Accordingly, the side flag members **812** move **822** in a direction that is substantially orthogonal to the elongated first track **814** and the sliding **820** direction of the screw clamp **816**.

(73) FIG. **14** is a perspective view of the mounting bracket **806** of the flag **710** (shown in FIG. **13**). FIG. **15** is a partial cross-sectional view of the mounting bracket **806**. Referring concurrently to FIGS. **14** and **15**, the mounting bracket **806** includes a riser **824** that is configured to couple to the front plate of the filter tray holder **704** (shown in FIG. **10**). The riser **824** is also configured to

releasably couple to one or more clamps **826** of the flag **710** (shown in FIG. **13**). The riser **824** includes a first undercut surface **828** and a first oblique surface **830**. The clamp **826** includes a second undercut surface **832** and a second oblique surface **834**. The clamp **826** is biased B by a spring **836** and a button **838**.

(74) In operation, the undercut surfaces **828**, **832** are configured to engage with each other and couple to the riser **824** to the clamp **826**. To release the clamp **826**, the button **838** is depressed so as to disengage the undercut surfaces **828**, **832**. Because the clamp **826** is spring biased, the oblique surfaces **830**, **834** enable the clamp **826** to snap into engagement with the riser **824**. The clamp **826** is slidable in a direction that is substantially parallel to the direction of the undercut surfaces **828**, **832** and the bias direction of the spring **836**.

(75) It will be clear that the systems and methods described herein are well adapted to attain the ends and advantages mentioned as well as those inherent therein. Those skilled in the art will recognize that the methods and systems within this specification may be implemented in many manners and as such is not to be limited by the foregoing exemplified embodiments and examples. In this regard, any number of the features of the different embodiments described herein may be combined into one single embodiment and alternate embodiments having fewer than or more than all of the features herein described are possible. It is to be understood that terminology employed herein is used for the purpose of describing particular examples only and is not intended to be limiting. It must be noted that, as used in this specification, the singular forms “a,” “an,” and “the” include plural referents unless the context clearly dictates otherwise.

(76) While various embodiments have been described for purposes of this disclosure, various changes and modifications may readily suggest themselves to those skilled in the art and may be made which are well within the scope of the present disclosure.

Claims

1. A filter reading system for a matte box for a camera, the filter reading system comprising: a filter holder defining a plurality of stages each configured to receive a filter, the filter holder configured to be positioned in front of a camera lens, the filter holder including a reader device; a filter tag configured to couple to the filter, the filter tag having filter information corresponding to the filter attached thereto; and a display device coupled in communication with the reader device, the display device having a display screen, wherein when the filter with the filter tag is inserted into a stage of the plurality of stages, the reader device is configured to read the filter information of the filter and detect stage position of the filter, and display the filter information and the stage position on the display screen.
2. The filter reading system of claim 1, wherein the filter holder includes a pair of sidewalls, the reader device disposed on one of the sidewalls.
3. The filter reading system of claim 1, wherein the filter tag is a radio-frequency identification (RFID) tag, and wherein the reader device is a RFID reader device.
4. The filter reading system of claim 1, further comprising a filter tray, the filter tray supporting the filter and configured to be at least partially received within the filter holder.
5. The filter reading system of claim 1, wherein the display device is wirelessly coupled in communication with the reader device.
6. The filter reading system of claim 1, wherein the display device is configured to couple in communication with a user device.
7. The filter reading system of claim 1, wherein the display device is battery powered.
8. The filter reading system of claim 1, wherein each stage of the plurality of stages includes an individual reader device.
9. The filter reading system of claim 1, wherein the filter tag is a read/write tag.
10. The filter reading system of claim 1, wherein the filter reading system is an upgrade kit

configured to integrate with an existing matte box.

11. A method of capturing filter information within a matte box for a camera, the method comprising: providing the matte box with a filter holder defining a plurality of stages in front of a camera lens; providing a filter having a filter tag, wherein the filter tag has filter information corresponding to the filter attached thereto; inserting the filter into one of the plurality of stages in the filter holder; reading the filter information of the filter and detecting stage position of the filter inserted into the filter holder via a reader device supported within the filter holder; and displaying, via a display device having a display screen coupled in communication with the reader device, the filter information and the stage position on the display screen.

12. The method of claim 11, further comprising writing the filter information on the filter tag.

13. The method of claim 12, wherein writing the filter information is performed using a user device coupled in communication to the display device.

14. The method of claim 11, further comprising recording time information of the filter within the filter holder.

15. The method of claim 14, wherein recording time information includes logging time or timecode.

16. The method of claim 11, wherein reading the filter information and detecting stage position is performed by radio-frequency identification (RFID).

17. The method of claim 11, wherein the filter is disposed within a filter tray, and inserting the filter into the filter holder includes at least partially inserting the filter tray within the filter holder.

18. The method of claim 11, wherein the filter holder includes a pair of sidewalls, the reader device disposed on one of the sidewalls, and wherein each stage of the plurality of stages includes an individual reader device such that reading the filter information and detecting stage position is performed individually for each of the plurality of stages.

19. The method of claim 11, further comprising mounting the display device on the matte box or the camera.

20. The method of claim 11, further comprising upgrading an existing matte box with the filter holder having the reader device.
